How to talk about power-building

Finance Operations · one of nine department pages · Justice Outside, 2026

> **About this sample.** Justice Outside describes its work as power-building, through three connected pillars: Advocate, Fund, and Build. I wrote and designed a speaking guide so every department could explain it in their own words. I interviewed each director first, then gave each team a role summary, a 30-second pitch, a 2-minute version, likely questions, and phrases that work. After the trainings, 100% of staff reported confidence explaining the model, against a 90% goal.

Your role in power-building

You manage grant administration, compliance, financial reporting, and the payment infrastructure that moves money to grantee partners. You absorb operational complexity so grantees do not have to.

When a grantee receives funding on time without unnecessary bureaucracy, that is your work making trust-based principles real.

Your 30-second pitch

> *I work in finance operations at Justice Outside. My job is to make sure trust-based funding reaches grantee partners on time and without unnecessary bureaucracy. When a grantee receives funding without onerous compliance demands, that's finance operations making power-building real. Compliance, infrastructure, and reporting all have to work in service of community.*

Your 2-minute version

Finance Ops is the operational backbone of the trust-based model.

On grant administration, we move funds to grantee partners on schedule, with minimal documentation burden on their side. We absorb the compliance complexity so they can focus on the work in their communities.

On compliance, we meet the requirements of our funders, the IRS, and our regulatory environment without passing those burdens on to grantees. That is a deliberate operational choice. It costs us more on the back end and saves grantee capacity, which is the point.

On reporting, we provide the financial transparency funders need to trust us with multi-million dollar grants, while keeping grantee reporting simple, narrative-led, and respectful of their time.

Questions you might get asked

Q: How is finance ops part of power-building?

When we get the operations right, grantees do not waste time on bureaucracy. That time goes back into their work. Every hour we save on the operational side is an hour grantees spend on the community side. That is power-building, even though it does not look like it from the outside.

Q: What's different about your compliance approach?

We meet legal and funder requirements without imposing them on grantees. Most intermediaries pass that complexity through. We absorb it.

Phrases that work

Operational infrastructure for the movement · Trust-based principles made operational · Absorbing complexity · Compliance that respects grantee capacity